BLAKE CULBERTSON

Computer Science Student & SOC Analyst
Arcata, CA | blake@blakeculbertson.com
GitHub: https://github.com/xizbow1

EXPERIENCE

Cal Poly Humboldt Security Operations Center, Arcata, CA — *Student SOC Analyst*

AUG 2026 - PRESENT

- Triage and investigate endpoint, identity, email, and network-security alerts using Elastic Security, CrowdStrike Falcon, Proofpoint, Microsoft Entra ID, Intune, MECM, and Qualys.
- Investigate account compromises by correlating authentication logs, MFA activity, endpoint telemetry, IP reputation, and email audit records.
- Analyze phishing messages, URLs, attachments, delivery records, and user activity; quarantine malicious email and assist with account containment.
- Develop and tune Elastic detection rules, queries, and exceptions to reduce false positives while preserving meaningful security coverage.
- Helped contain compromised accounts used to distribute phishing messages to thousands of university recipients.

Cal Poly Humboldt IT Help Desk, Arcata, CA — *Tier 1 Help Desk Technician*

DEC 2024 - AUG 2026

- Provided Tier 1 help desk support for students, faculty, and staff, troubleshooting hardware, software, and account-related issues.
- Used user management systems to verify accounts, reset credentials, and assist users with access requests.
- Processed and triaged support tickets, documenting issues and escalating unresolved cases according to established procedures.

SKILLS

- **Security:** Elastic Security/Kibana, CrowdStrike Falcon, Proofpoint, Microsoft Entra ID, Intune, MECM, Qualys
- **Technical:** Incident triage, phishing analysis, identity investigation, endpoint investigation, detection-rule tuning

EDUCATION

California State Polytechnic University, Humboldt, Arcata, CA — *Bachelor of Science in Computer Science*

EXPECTED DECEMBER 2026

GPA: 3.88

First Place — 2025 Cal Poly Humboldt Hackathon for Social Good